

LIFE Data File: Variable list and specification

Variable	Format	Label
Identifier information:		
COUNTRY	4.0	Country of focus
COMMUN	4.0	Community number
SURVEYPL	4.0	Place of survey
SURVEYYR	4.0	Year of survey
HHNUM	4.0	Household number (within community)
Sample-specific weight:		
WEIGHT	6.2	Weight
Background information (time-constant):		
SEX	4.0	Sex
YRBORN	4.0	Year of birth
STATEBRN	4.0	State of birth
PLACEBRN	4.0	Place of birth
OCC	4.0	Principal occupation
U.S. Migration Experience (time-constant):		
USBORN	4.0	Born abroad
USYR1	4.0	First U.S. mig: Year
USDUR1	4.0	First U.S. mig: Duration (in months)
USDOC1	4.0	First U.S. mig: Documentation used
USSTATE1	4.0	First U.S. mig: State of residence
USPLACE1	4.0	First U.S. mig: City of residence
USMAR1	4.0	First U.S. mig: Married
USOCC1	4.0	First U.S. mig: Occupation
USWAGE1	14.2	First U.S. mig: Wage
USBY1	4.0	First U.S. mig: Frequency of wages
USYRL	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Year
USDURL	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Duration (in months)
USDOCL	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Documentation used
USSTATEL	4.0	Last U.S. mig: State of residence
USPLACEL	4.0	Last U.S. mig: City of residence
USMARL	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Married
USOCCL	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Occupation
USWAGEL	14.2	Last U.S. mig: Wage
USBYL	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Frequency of wages

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Variable	Format	Label
HOWJOB	4.0	Last U.S. mig: How job was obtained
HRWAGE	8.2	Last U.S. mig: Hourly wage
HRWEEK	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Usual hours worked per week
MONSYR	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Usual months worked per year
HOWPAID	4.0	Last U.S. mig: How wages paid
SSTAX	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Social security taxes withheld
FEDTX	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Federal taxes withheld
ROWNER	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Race of employer
RSUPER	4.0	Last U.S. mig: Race of supervisor
LEGYRAPP	4.0	Legalization: Year of residency application
LEGYRREC	4.0	Legalization: Year residency received
LEGSPON	4.0	Legalization: Sponsor
CITYRAPP	4.0	Citizenship: Year of application
CITYRREC	4.0	Citizenship: Year received
USTRIPS	4.0	Total number of U.S. migrations
USEXP	8.2	Total months of U.S. experience
USCURTRP	4.0	Currently on last U.S. migration

Domestic Migration Experience (time-constant):

DOYR1	4.0	First domestic trip: Year
DODUR1	4.0	First domestic trip: Duration (in months)
DOSTATE1	4.0	First domestic trip: Department of residence
DOPLACE1	4.0	First domestic trip: Municipio of residence
DOOCC1	4.0	First domestic trip: Occupation
DOYRL	4.0	Last domestic trip: Year
DODURL	4.0	Last domestic trip: Duration (in months)
DOSTATEL	4.0	Last domestic trip: Department of residence
DOPLACEL	4.0	Last domestic trip: Municipio of residence
DOOCCL	4.0	Last domestic trip: Occupation
DOWAGEL	8.2	Last domestic trip: Wage
DOBYL	4.0	Last domestic trip: Frequency of wages
DOTRIPS	4.0	Total number of domestic migrations

Person-year information (time-specific):

YEAR	4.0	Year
LIFEYR	4.0	Year in life history
AGE	4.0	Age

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Variable	Format	Label
EDUC	4.0	Educational attainment
<i>Labor force information (time-specific):</i>		
OCCUP	4.0	Occupation
JCHANGE	4.0	Job change
JOBNUM	4.0	Job number
JOBDUR	4.0	Duration (months) in job in PY
JDURTOT	4.0	Total duration (months) in current job
JOBPLACE	4.0	City/place of job
JOBSTATE	4.0	State of job
PENSION	4.0	Type of Social Security or a pension offered by the job
<i>Migration/duration information (time-specific):</i>		
INUS	4.0	In U.S.
TRIP	4.0	New trip
TRIPNUM	4.0	Estimated trip number
USDOC	4.0	U.S. documentation
GREEN	4.0	Green card?
CITIZEN	4.0	Citizen
USDUR	4.0	Months spent in U.S.
USCUMEXP	4.0	Cumulative U.S. experience (months)
<i>Union (marital) information (time-specific):</i>		
CUNION	1.0	In a consensual union during person-year
FLAGCUN	1.0	FLAG variable for CUNION
MARRIED	1.0	Married during person-year
FLAGMAR	1.0	FLAG variable for MARRIED
<i>Family composition (time-specific, except for CEB):</i>		
CEB	2.0	Children: Total ever born (constant)
CEBSOFAR	2.0	Children: Total born prior to or during person-year
MINORS	2.0	Children: Total under 18 years
CHILDREN	2.0	Children: Total living
CHILDBRN	2.0	Children: Total born in person-year
CHILDEAD	2.0	Children: Total dead in person-year
<i>International migration experience among family of origin (time-specific):</i>		
FAUSMIG	1.0	Father: Any U.S. migration experience prior to/ during PY

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Variable	Format	Label
FLAGFAUS	1.0	FLAG variable for FAUSMIG
MOUSMIG	1.0	Mother: Any U.S. migration experience prior to/ during PY
FLAGMOUS	1.0	FLAG variable for MOUSMIG
BROUSMIG	2.0	Brothers: No. with U.S. migration experience prior to/during PY
FLAGBRUS	1.0	FLAG variable for BROUSMIG
SISUSMIG	2.0	Sisters: No. with U.S. migration experience prior to/ during PY
FLAGSIUS	1.0	FLAG variable for SISUSMIG

Property and Business holdings (time-specific):

LAND	1.0	Number of land parcels owned in person-year
FLAGLAND	1.0	FLAG variable for LAND
AREA	6.1	Number of hectares owned in person-year
FLAGAREA	1.0	FLAG variable for HECTARS
PROPERTY	1.0	Number of properties owned in person-year
FLAGPROP	1.0	FLAG variable for PROPERTY
BUSINESS	1.0	Number of businesses owned in person-year
FLAGBUS	1.0	FLAG variable for BUSINESS

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
<i>Identifier Information</i>			
COUNTRY	Country of focus	10	El Salvador
COMMUN	Community number		(See Appendix A for codes and descriptions)
SURVEYPL	Place of survey	1 2	Home country US community
SURVEYYR	Year of survey		(See Appendix A for survey periods)
		yyyy	Year
HHNUM	Household number (within community)	nnnn	Number of household
<i>Sample-Specific Weight:</i>			
WEIGHT	Weight	nnn.nn	Weight
<i>Background Information (time-constant):</i>			
SEX	Sex	1 2	Male Female
YRBORN	Year of birth	yyyy	Year
STATEBRN	State of birth		(See Appendix C for State codes)
PLACEBRN	Place of birth		(See Appendix B for Place codes)
		9999	Unknown
OCC	Principal occupation		(See Appendix D for occupation codes)

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
<i>U.S. Migration Experience (time-constant):</i>			
USBORN	Born in U.S.		
		1	Yes
		2	No
USYR1 - USYRL	First/last U.S. mig: Year		
		yyyy	Year
		8888	N/A (never migrated to the U.S.)
USDUR1 - USDURL	First/last U.S. mig: Duration (in months)		
		nnn	Number of months
		8888	N/A (never migrated to the U.S.)
USDOC1 - USDOCL	First/last U.S. mig: Documentation used		
		1	Legal resident
		2	Contract – Bracero (1942-1964)
		3	Contract - H2A/H2B (agricultural)
		4	Temporary: Worker
		5	Temporary: Tourist/visitor
		6	Citizen
		8	Undocumented (includes false documents)
		9	Refugee / asylum
		10	TPS – Temporary Protected Status
		11	NACARA – Nicaraguan Adjustment and Central American Relief Act
		12	Permit through the spouse
		13	Other
		8888	N/A (never migrated to the U.S.)
		9999	Unknown
USSTATE1 - USSTATEL	First/last U.S. mig: State of residence		
			(See Appendix C for state codes)
		8888	N/A (never migrated to the U.S.)
USPLACE1 - USPLACEL	First/last U.S. mig: City of residence		
			(See Appendix B for place codes)
		8888	N/A (never migrated to the U.S.)
		9999	Unknown
USMAR1 - USMARL	First/last U.S. mig: Married		
		1	Yes
		2	No
		8888	N/A (never migrated to the U.S.)

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
USOCC1 - USOCCL	First/last U.S. mig: Occupation		
			(See Appendix D for occupation codes)
		8888	N/A (never migrated to the U.S.)
		9999	Unknown
USWAGE1 - USWAGEL	First/last mig: Wage		
		nnn.dd	Amount
		8888	N/A (not employed for wages / never migrated)
		9999	Unknown
USBY1 - USBYL	First/last U.S. mig: Frequency of wages		
		1	Hour
		2	Day
		3	Week
		4	Biweekly
		5	Month
		6	Year
		8888	N/A (not employed for wages / never migrated)
		9999	Unknown
HOWJOB	Last U.S. mig: How job was obtained		
		1	Searched by oneself
		2	Recommended by a relative
		3	Recommended by a friend
		4	Recommended by a fellow home-community member
		5	Recommended by a coyote
		6	Contracted
		7	Paid a friend/fellow home-community member
		8	Through an employer agency
		9	"Pick-up" on street corner
		8888	N/A (Did not work during last trip)
		9999	Unknown
HRWAGE	Last U.S. mig: Hourly wage		
		nnn.dd	Hourly wage
		8888	N/A (Did not work during last trip)
		9999	Unknown
HRWEEK	Last U.S. mig: Usual hours worked per week		
		nnn	Number of hours
		8888	N/A (Did not work during last trip)
		9999	Unknown

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
MONSYR	Last U.S. mig: Usual months worked per year	nn	Number of months
		8888	N/A (Did not work during last trip)
		9999	Unknown
HOWPAID	Last U.S. mig: How wages paid	1	By check
		2	By cash
		8888	N/A (Did not work during last trip)
		9999	Unknown
SSTAX	Last U.S. mig: Social Security taxes withheld	1	Yes
		2	No
		8888	N/A (Did not work during last trip)
		9999	Unknown
FEDTX	Last U.S. mig: Federal taxes withheld	1	Yes
		2	No
		8888	N/A (Did not work during last trip)
		9999	Unknown
ROWNER	Last U.S. mig: Race of employer	1	Anglo
		2	African-American
		3	Asian
		4	Chicano
		5	Salvadorian
		6	Other Latino
		7	Other
		8	Company
		8888	N/A (Did not work during last trip)
RSUPER	Last U.S. mig: Race of supervisor	1	Anglo
		2	African-American
		3	Asian
		4	Chicano
		5	Salvadorian
		6	Other Latino

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
		7	Other
		8	Company
		8888	N/A (Did not work during last trip)
		9999	Unknown
LEGYRAPP	Legalization: Year of residency application		
		yyyy	Year
		8888	N/A (never migrated / never applied)
		9999	Unknown
LEGYRREC	Legalization: Year of residency received		
		yyyy	Year
		8888	N/A (never migrated / never applied)
		9999	Unknown
LEGSPON	Legalization: Sponsor		
		1	Spouse
		2	Child
		3	Parent
		4	Sibling
		5	Amnesty (Rodino / IRCA: 1987-1989)
		6	Special Agricultural Workers (SAW)
		7	Employer
		8	TPS – Temporary Protected Status
		9	NACARA – Nicaraguan Adjustment and Central American Relief Act
		10	Other
		8888	N/A (never migrated / never applied)
		9999	Unknown
CITYRAPP	Citizenship: Year of residency application		
		yyyy	Year
		8888	N/A (never migrated / never applied)
		9999	Unknown
CITYRREC	Citizenship: Year of residency received		
		yyyy	Year
		8888	N/A (never migrated / never applied)
USTRIPS	Total number of U.S. trips		
		nnn	Number of international trips
USEXP	Total months of U.S. experience		
		nnn	Number of months

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
		8888	See Appendix E
USCURTRP	Currently on last U.S. migration		
		1	Yes
		2	No
		8888	N/A (never migrated)
<i>Domestic Migration Experience (time-constant):</i>			
DOYR1 - DOYRL	First/last domestic mig: Year		
		yyyy	Year
		8888	N/A (never migrated internally)
		9999	Unknown
DODUR1 - DODURL	First/last domestic mig: Duration (in months)		
		nnn	Number of months
		8888	N/A (never migrated internally)
		9999	Unknown
DOSTATE1 - DOSTATEL	First/last domestic mig: Department of residence		
			(See Appendix C for Department codes)
		8888	N/A (never migrated internally)
		9999	Unknown
DOPLACE1 - DOPLACEL	First/last domestic mig: City of residence		
			(See Appendix B for place codes)
		8888	N/A (never migrated internally)
		9999	Unknown
DOOCC1 - DOOCCL	First/last domestic mig: Occupation		
			(See Appendix D for occupation codes)
		8888	N/A (never migrated internally)
		9999	Unknown
DOWAGEL	First/last domestic mig: Wage		
		nnn.dd	Amount
		8888	N/A (never worked for wages/ never migrated)
		9999	Unknown
DOBYL	First/last domestic mig: Frequency of wages		
		1	Hour
		2	Day
		3	Week

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
		4	Biweekly
		5	Month
		6	Year
		8888	N/A (never worked for wages/ never migrated)
		9999	Unknown
DOTRIPS	Total number of domestic migrations		
		nnn	Number of domestic trips
Person-year information (time-specific):			
YEAR	Year		
		yyyy	Year
LIFEYR	Year in life history		
		1	First person-year
		2	Intervening person-years
		3	Last person-year
AGE	Age		
		nn	Age
EDUC	Educational Attainment		
		nn	Number of years completed
		9999	Unknown
Labor force information (time-specific):			
OCCUP	Occupation		
			(See Appendix D for Occupation codes)
		0	Prior to labor force entry
		9999	Unknown
JCHANGE	Job change		
		0	No job change during PY
		1	Job change during PY
JOBNUM	Job number		
		nn	(Estimated) job number
JOBDUR	Duration (months) in job in PY		
		nn	Number of months

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
JDURTOT	Total duration (months) in current job	nnn	Number of months
		9999	Unknown
JOBPLACE	City/place of job		(See Appendix B for Place codes)
		0	Prior to labor force entry
		9999	Unknown
JOBSTATE	State of job		(See Appendix C for Place codes)
		0	Prior to labor force entry
PENSION	Type of Social Security or a pension offered by the job	0	None (prior to labor force entry)
		1	Yes
		2	No
		8888	N/A (no work)
		9999	Unknown
Migration/duration information (time-specific):			
INUS	In U.S.	0	No
		1	Yes
TRIP	New trip	0	No
		1	Yes
TRIPNUM	Estimated trip number	nn	Number
TRIPDUR	Total duration (months) of trip	nnn	Number of months
USDOC	Documentation abroad	0	N/A (Not abroad during person-year)
		1	Legal resident
		2	Contract – Bracero (1942-1964)
		3	Contract - H2A/H2B (agricultural)
		4	Temporary: Worker

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
		5	Temporary: Tourist/visitor
		6	Citizen
		8	Undocumented (includes false documents)
		9	Refugee / asylum
		10	TPS – Temporary Protected Status
		11	NACARA – Nicaraguan Adjustment and Central American Relief Act
		12	Permit through the spouse
		13	Other
GREEN	Green card?		
		0	No
		1	Yes
		9999	Unknown
CITIZEN	Citizne?		
		0	No
		1	Yes
USDUR	Months spent in U.S.		
		nn	Number of months
USCUMEXP	Cumulative expedience in U.S. (months)		
		nn	Number of months
<i>Union (marital) information (time-specific) (1-4):</i>			
CUNION (see Note 1)	In consensual union during person-year		
		0	Not in a consensual union in person-year
		1	In consensual union in person-year
FLAGCUN (see Note 2)	FLAG variable for CUNION		
		0	All consensual unions could be located in time
		1	At least one consensual union couldn't be located in time
MARRIED (see Note 1)	Married during person-year		
		0	Not married in person-year
		1	Married in person-year
FLAGMAR (see Note 2)	FLAG variable for MARRIED		
		0	All marriages could be located in time
		1	At least one marriage couldn't be located in time

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
<i>Family composition (time-specific, except for CEB):</i>			
CEB	Children: Total ever born (constant) as of survey year	nn	Number of children
CEBSOFAR (see Note 3)	Children: Total born prior to or during person-year	nn	Number of children
MINORS (see Note 3)	Children: Total under 18 years	nn	Number of children under 18 as of person-year
CHILDREN (see Note 3)	Children: Total living	nn	Number living as of person-year
CHILDBRN (see Note 3)	Children: Total born in person-year	nn	Number born during person-year
CHILDEAD (see Note 3)	Children: Total dead in person-year	nn	Number dead during person-year
<i>International migration experience among family of origin (time-specific):</i>			
FAUSMIG (see Note 1)	Father: Any U.S. migration experience prior to or during PY	0 1	No Yes
FLAGFAUS (see Note 2)	FLAG variable for FAUSMIG	0 1	Father's migration experience (if any) could be located in time Father is a migrant, but his migration experience could not be located in time
MOUSMIG (see Note 1)	Mother: Any U.S. migration experience prior to or during PY	0 1	No Yes
FLAGMOUS (see Note 2)	FLAG variable for MOUSMIG	0 1	Mother's migration experience (if any) could be located in time Mother is a migrant, but his migration experience could not be located in time
BROUSMIG (see Note 1)	Brother: No. of brothers with U.S. migration experience prior to or during PY	nn	Number of brothers

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
FLAGBRUS (see Note 2)	FLAG variable for BRABMIG		
		0	Brother's migration experience (if any) could be located in time
		1	Brother is a migrant, but his migration experience could not be located in time
SISUSMIG (see Note 1)	Sister: No. of sisters with U.S. migration experience prior to or during PY		
		nn	Number of sisters
FLAGSIUS (see Note 2)	FLAG variable for SIABMIG		
		0	Sisters' migration experience (if any) could be located in time
		1	Sister is a migrant, but his migration experience could not be located in time
<i>Current land holdings (time-specific) (1-4):</i>			
LAND (see Note 1)	Number of land parcels owned in person-year		
		nn	Number of land parcels
FLAGLAND (see Note 2)	FLAG variable for LAND		
		0	All lands' ownership (if any) could be located in time
		1	At least one land could not be located in time
HECTARS (see Note 1)	Number of hectares owned in person-year		
		nnnn.n	Number of hectares
FLAGHECT (see Note 2)	FLAG variable for HECTARS		
		0	All hectares' ownership (if any) could be located in time
		1	At least one hectare could not be located in time
<i>Property and Business holdings (time-specific):</i>			
PROPERTY (see Note 1)	Number of properties owned in person-year		
		nn	Number of properties
FLAGPROP (see Note 2)	FLAG variable for PROPERTY		
		0	All properties' ownership (if any) could be located in time
		1	At least one property could not be located in time
BUSINESS (see Note 1)	Number of businesses owned in person-year		
		nnnn.n	Number of businesses

LIFE Data File: Variable Codes

Variable	Label	Value	Definition
FLAGBUS (see Note 2)	FLAG variable for BUSINESS		
		0	All businesses' ownership (if any) could be located in time
		1	At least one business could not be located in time

NOTE 1

Variables CUNION, MARRIED, MOUSMIG, FAUSMIG, SISUSMIG, BROUSMIG, LAND, HECTARS, PROPERTY and BUSINESS were computed from information provided in HOUSE file on union history of the household head, migratory experience of the household head's family of origin, and history of property and business holdings. For each of these, HOUSE file provides event years (e.g., property acquisition year, year of marriage dissolution, etc.)

In order to compute the variables mentioned above, we ignored those unions, marriages, migration experience of siblings, land parcels, hectares owned, properties and businesses that could not be located in time. In other words, the variables presented in LIFE file were built under the following simplifying assumptions:

- (a) unions and marriages which began or ended in unknown years never happened,
- (b) siblings who migrated abroad in an unspecified year were never abroad,
- (c) land, properties or businesses acquired or sold in unspecified years never existed.
- (d) land parcels of unspecified dimensions had zero hectares (provided that years of acquisition and sale were available, these parcels were used in the computation of the LAND variable but ignored in the computation of the HECTARS variable.)

NOTE 2

For each of the following variables we provide a corresponding dichotomous FLAG variable, which is not time-varying:

- CUNION: flag variable FLAGCUN
- MARRIED: flag variable FLAGMAR
- FAUSMIG: flag variable FLAGFAUS
- MOUSMIG: flag variable FLAGMOUS
- BROUSMIG: flag variable FLAGBRUS
- SISUSMIG: flag variable FLAGSIUS
- LAND: flag variable FLAGLAND
- HECTARS: flag variable FLAGHECT
- PROPERTY: flag variable FLAGPROP
- BUSINESS: flag variable FLAGBUS

As it can be seen in the codebook, a value of 1 in the FLAG variable indicates that the event in question did occur, but it is not possible to reliably locate it in time. For example, consider a household head who has been married only once, but for whom the year this marriage started or ended is unknown. In such a case, the value of MARRIED will be zero throughout her/his life history, but the value of FLAGMAR will be one to indicate that the event (marriage) did occur, but at an unspecified time. The same logic can be applied to the other dichotomous variables listed above: CUNION, FAUSMIG and MOUSMIG.

In the case of the non-dichotomous variables BROUSMIG, SISUSMIG, LAND, PROPERTY and BUSINESS, their FLAG variables indicate that at least one event could not be located in time. For example, a value of 3 in BROUSMIG coupled with a value of 1 for FLAGBRUS indicates that it is certain that, as of or during the person-year, three brothers of the household head have been abroad. However, there is at least one more brother who has been abroad at an unspecified time, which could have been before that person-year.

Finally, a value of one in FLAGHECT indicates that, either: a) there is at least one plot of land that was acquired or sold at an unspecified time, or b) there is at least one plot of land of unspecified hectares.

NOTE 3

In the construction of the following variables, children born or dead in unknown years were omitted: CEBFAR, MINORS, CHILDREN, CHILDBRN, CHILDEAD. All children ever born are included in variable CEB, which can be used to measure the extent of this omission.